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Dear Hiring Manager,

The childcare legal assistant role at Southwark appeals to me because my background in case preparation, client-facing legal advice and procedural work maps closely onto what a local authority legal team handles day to day, even though my direct childcare law exposure is limited. I want to be upfront about that gap while showing why my experience is genuinely transferable.

At Citizens Advice East Berkshire I advise clients across housing, welfare benefits, employment and family matters. A significant part of that work involves interviewing people in difficult circumstances, taking detailed factual statements, identifying the legal and evidential issues, and managing their matters through to completion. Clients are often vulnerable, and explaining procedural requirements clearly and without alarming them is something I have had to develop deliberately. That experience of working with real people under pressure, rather than just with documents, is what I think crosses over most directly into a childcare caseload.

At BCLP I spent a year supporting live contentious matters. In the arbitration team I became the only junior on a complex investment arbitration shortly before a significant submission deadline. I coordinated documents across the team, tracked outstanding actions, maintained the case file and helped ensure on-time delivery. The real estate disputes team gave me a different kind of exposure: reviewing large volumes of documents, preparing electronic hearing bundles, assisting with skeleton arguments and court materials, and keeping organised records across several matters with competing deadlines. Both rotations required the kind of file management and deadline discipline that procedural court work demands.

What draws me to a local authority role specifically is the public interest dimension. At Citizens Advice I regularly deal with matters where the right outcome has real consequences for a client's housing, income or family situation, and that context shapes how I approach the work. A childcare caseload sits in the same space, and I would rather work in a setting where the stakes are visible than one where they are not.

I am available immediately and would welcome the chance to discuss how my experience fits the team's needs.

Yours sincerely,
Maria Silva